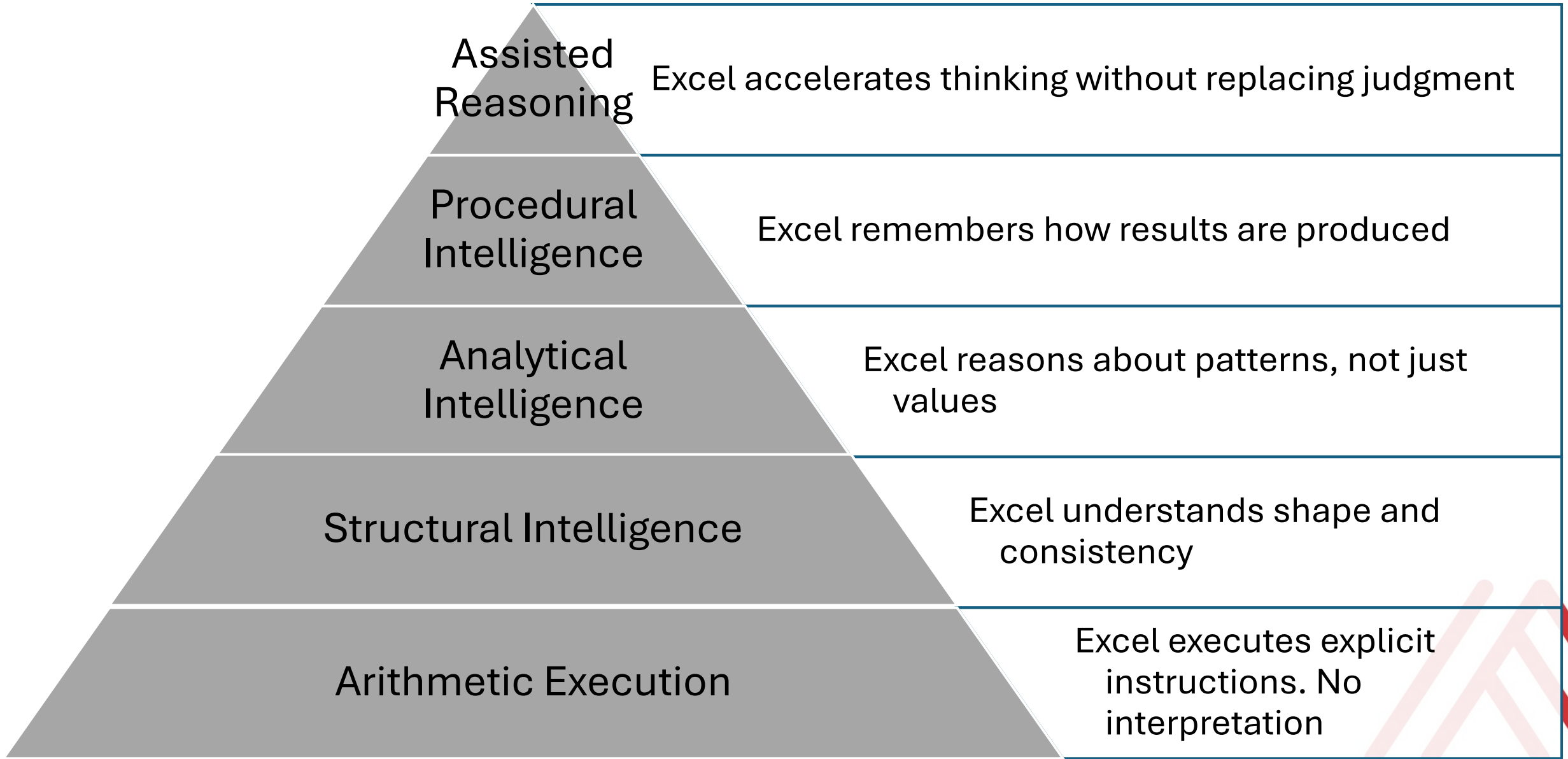
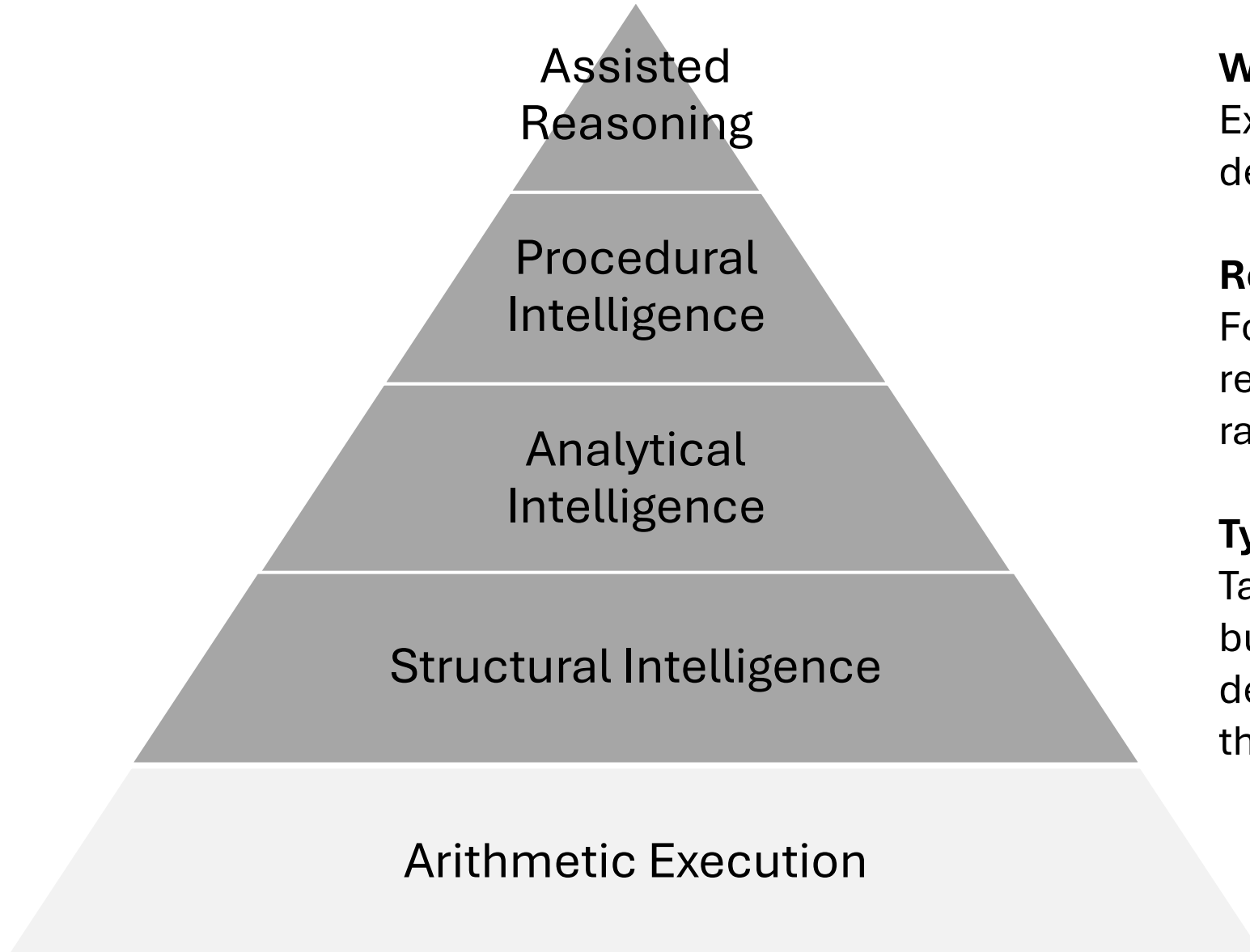


A hierarchy of Excel intelligence



Level 1: Arithmetic Execution



What Excel knows how to do:

Execute explicit instructions deterministically.

Representative tools/features:

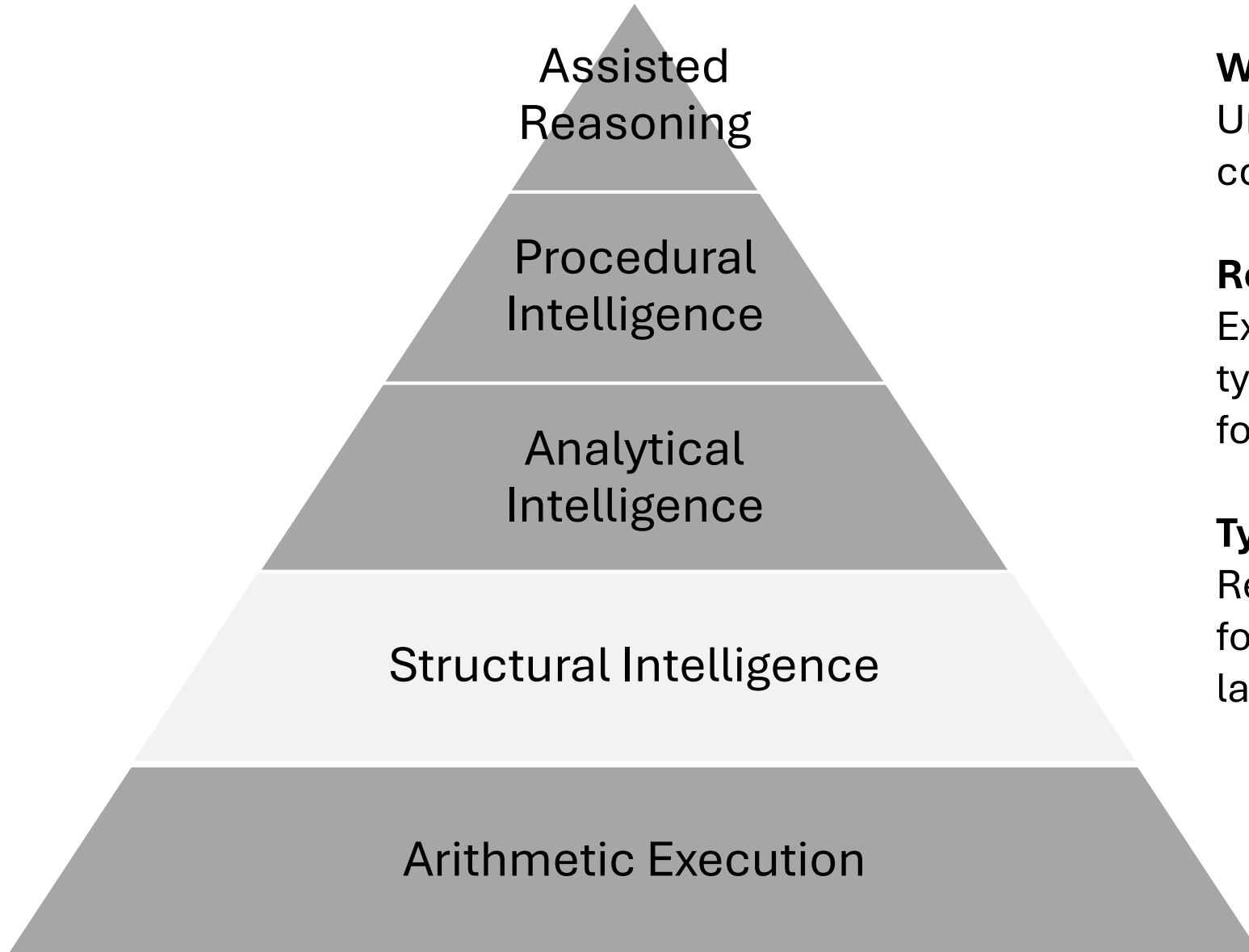
Formulas (SUM, IF, XLOOKUP), cell references, calculation engine, named ranges.

Typical use cases:

Tax and commission calculations, basic business rules, sanity checks, deterministic model logic (“if this, then that”).



Level 2: Structural Intelligence



What Excel knows how to do:

Understand data shape and enforce consistency

Representative tools/features:

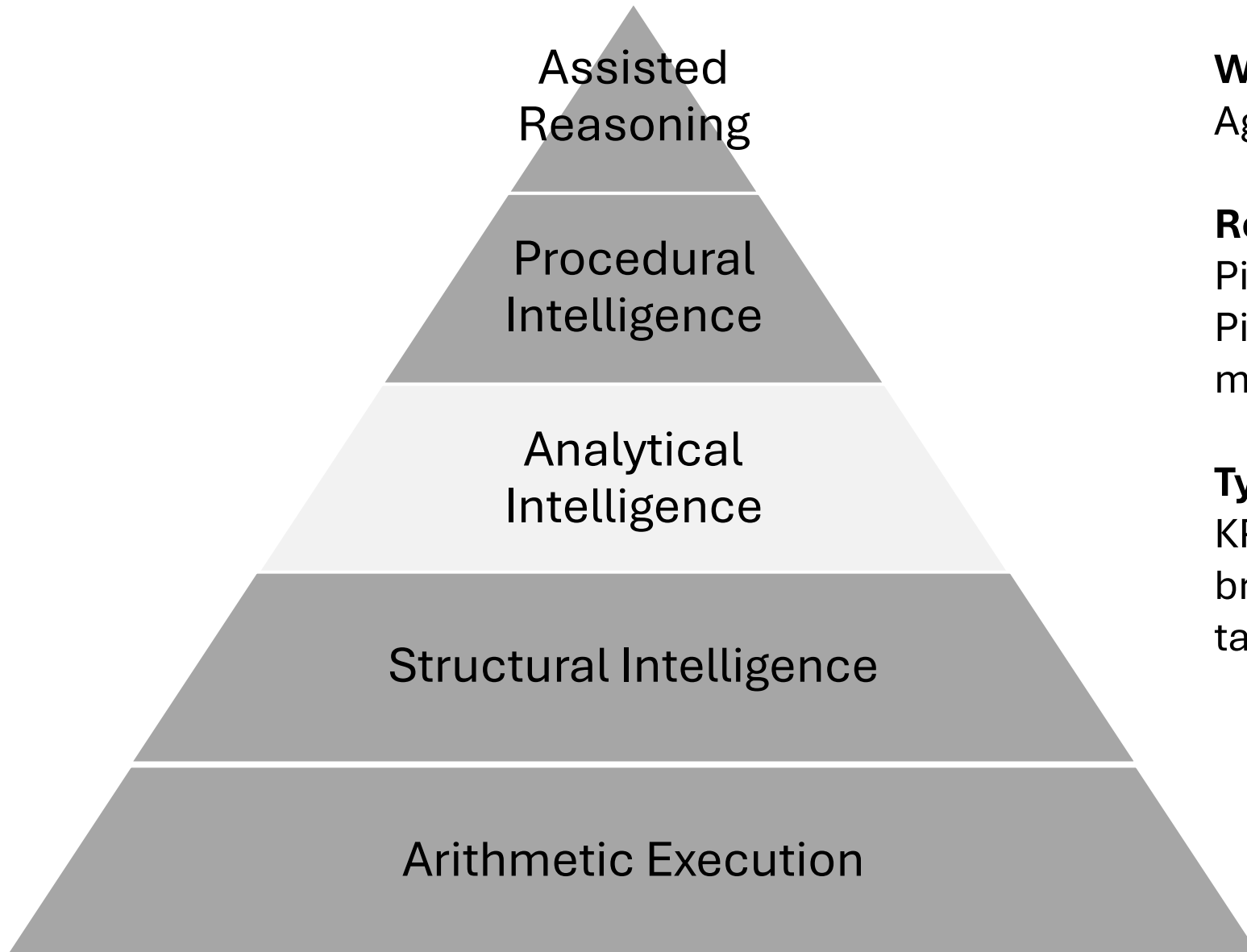
Excel Tables, structured references, data types, data validation, conditional formatting rules

Typical use cases:

Reliable data inputs, preventing broken formulas, standardized datasets, reducing layout-driven errors



Level 3: Analytical Intelligence



What Excel knows how to do:

Aggregate, group, filter, and relate data

Representative tools/features:

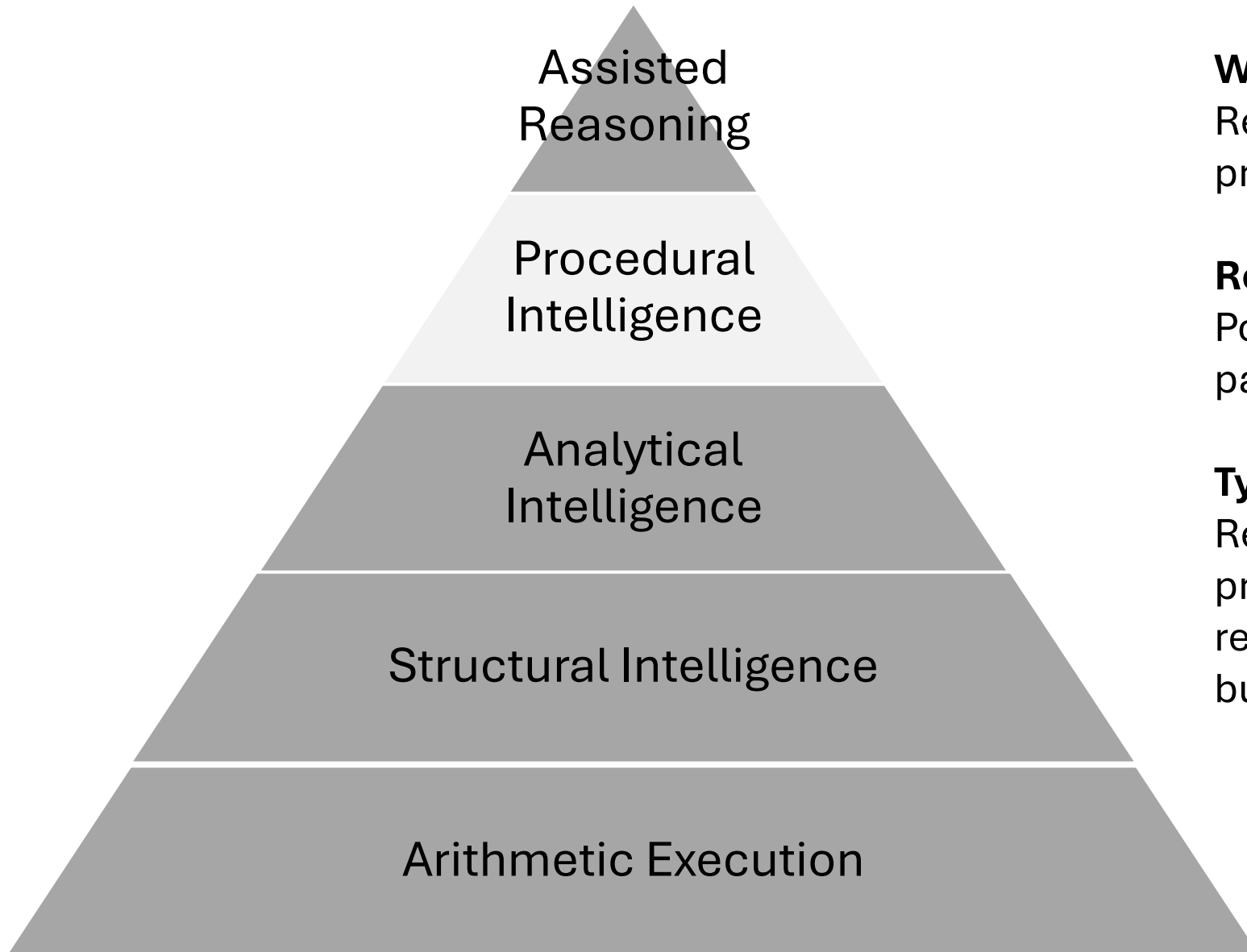
PivotTables and PivotCharts, slicers, Power Pivot data model, relationships, DAX measures

Typical use cases:

KPI reporting, cohort summaries, trend breakdowns, cross-tab analysis, multi-table analysis without fragile formulas



Level 4: Procedural Intelligence



What Excel knows how to do:

Remember and reproduce how results are produced

Representative tools/features:

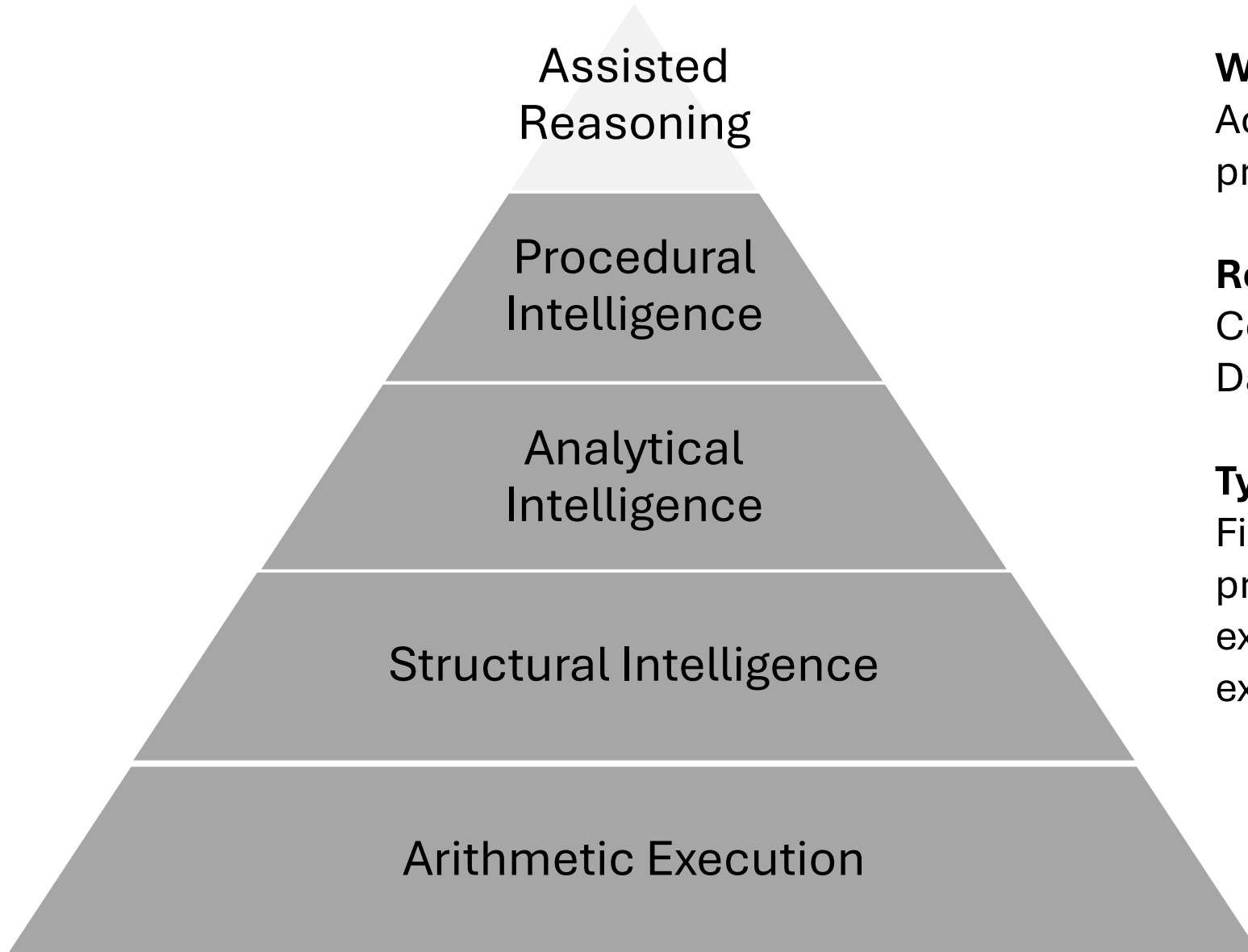
Power Query (M), refreshable connections, parameters, query dependencies

Typical use cases:

Repeatable ETL, monthly close preparation, cleaning messy exports, reshaping data for downstream analysis, building refreshable pipelines



Level 5: Assisted Reasoning



What Excel knows how to do:

Accelerate exploration and drafting through probabilistic assistance

Representative tools/features:

Copilot in Excel, Python in Excel, Analyze Data / insights-style features, Agent Mode

Typical use cases:

First-pass analysis planning, quick visual prototypes, code and formula drafting, explanation and documentation, “help me explore this dataset” workflows

